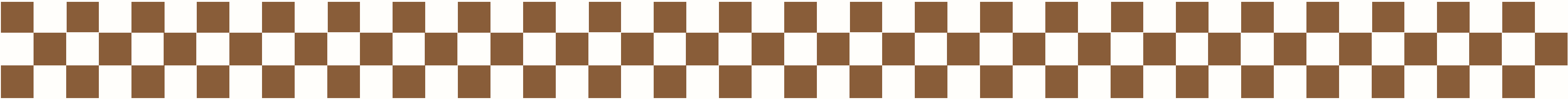




The Nitro Bar





Executive Summary

- Nitro Bar was founded in 2016 by Audrey Finocchiaro and Sam Lancaster as a modest coffee cart built in Audrey's basement. The founders took the cart throughout Providence, Rhode Island, building brand awareness by serving nitro cold brew at farmers markets, Brown University, and community events across the city.
- This grassroots, event-driven approach helped Nitro Bar establish strong local recognition, ultimately leading to the opening of the company's first brick-and-mortar location in Providence in 2018. The store's success accelerated the brand's growth trajectory.
- Today, Nitro Bar operates three retail locations, employs over 60 team members, and supplies nitro cold brew to more than 70 tap locations across the region.

Key Recommendations:

- Develop a short-form video series showcasing the "Nitro Moment", positioning Nitro Bar as a 5-minute social reset within a busy day
- Highlight both the café experience and the craftsmanship behind Nitro Bar's menu through location-based storytelling that emphasizes quality, creativity, and community.
- Partner with micro lifestyle and coffee influencers in target East Coast cities to build regional digital awareness
- Launch interactive campaigns (ex: "Sip Across States") to encourage engagement and signal expansion interest

Goals:

- Increase national brand awareness beyond Rhode Island
- Strengthen Nitro Bar's positioning as a premium, craft-focused coffee brand with a distinct social identity.
- Drive online sales of coffee beans and merchandise





Current Social Media Audit

Platforms:

- Tiktok: 570.6k
- Instagram: 167k
- Facebook: 2.3k

Instagram:

- Strong follower base
- High engagement on product-focused and founder-led content
- Consistent emphasis on aesthetic food and beverage visuals

TikTok:

- Performs well with short-form, personality-driven content
- Founder presence increases authenticity
- Challenges, behind-the-scenes, and interactive community prompts content generate interaction

Facebook:

- Lower engagement
- Limited strategic value for Gen Z target audience



Content strengths

- Strong regional brand identity
- Founder-led storytelling enhances authenticity
- High-quality product visuals reinforce craftsmanship
- Content feels genuine, community-oriented, and approachable

Content weaknesses

- Content primarily appeals to local Rhode Island audience
- Limited geo-targeted national awareness efforts
- Limited emphasis on customer interaction within the space – content focuses on products but underrepresents how guests engage with the environment and atmosphere.
- Underutilized opportunity to promote e-commerce (beans & merch)

Competitors: Blue Bottle, Blank Street, La Colombe

- Nitro Bar has strong local identity
- Lacks national digital positioning.
- Has strong potential for geographic expansion (currently exploring entry into the NYC market).



Target Audience



Demographics

- Age: 18–30
- Education: College students & early-career professionals
- Income: Middle to upper-middle income
- Location: Urban & walkable cities (e.g., Boston, NYC, DC)

Psychographics

- Value quality and craftsmanship over convenience
- Seek aesthetically curated environments
- View cafés as social and lifestyle spaces, not simply transactional stops
- Interested in creative food and beverage innovation
- Associate brands with identity and personal taste



Target Audience

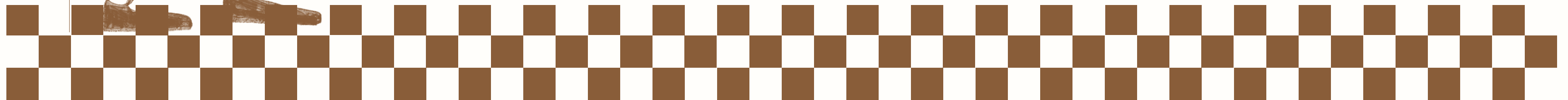


Behavioral Insights

- Visit cafés 3–5 times per week
- Frequently post food & drink experiences on social media
- Likely to purchase specialty coffee beans and branded merchandise
- Influenced by peer recommendations and micro-influencers

Social Media Habits

- Heavy Instagram and TikTok users
- Engage most with short-form video content
- Respond well to behind-the-scenes storytelling
- Participate in interactive features (Q&A, voting, giveaways)



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Types of Content:

Craft Over Convenience

- Emphasize innovation, ingredients, and process
- Show the dedication and passion that goes into the menu

The Nitro Reset

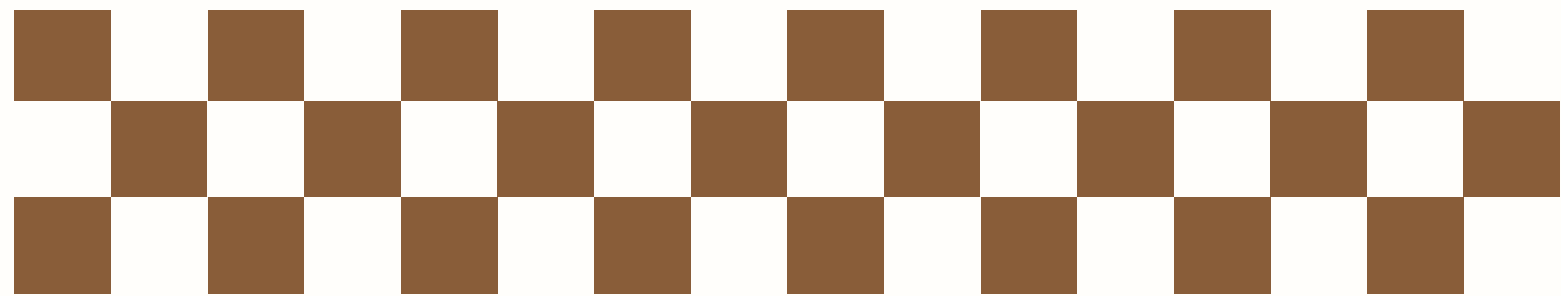
- Promote Nitro as a 10-minute social and mental reset
- Highlight atmosphere + ambiance

Coffee as Culture

- Position Nitro as embedded in exploration, travel, and routine
- “Nitro Bar: A Staple of the Rhode Island Experience”

Creative Menu Innovation

- Keep featuring seasonal drops
- Highlight experimentation



Content Strategy



Content Strategy

Instagram (Premium + Curated Identity)

Types of Content

- Reels: cinematic drink creation
- Carousel posts: flavor storytelling
- Stories: daily café atmosphere
- UGC reposts

Posting Frequency

- 4–5 posts per week
- Daily Stories
- 2–3 Reels weekly

TikTok (Energy + Personality + Reach)

Types of Content

- Founder-led storytelling
- Barista POV videos
- Seasonal menu reveals
- Behind-the-scenes experimentation

Posting Frequency

- 3–4 videos per week

Campaign Concepts

1. The “Nitro Moment” Series

- Before/after vibe transitions
- Chaotic morning → Nitro calm
- Short-form reset moments

2. “Inside the Menu” Series

- How a drink was created
- Why certain ingredients were chosen
- Innovation spotlight

3. City-Based Content

“If Every State Were a Nitro Drink” Series

- Create state-inspired drink concepts
- Tag and geo-target each state
- Encourage followers to comment where they’re from

Micro-Influencer PR Seeding Campaign

- Send curated Nitro tasting kits (beans + merch) to creators in target cities
- Encourage “First Nitro Experience” content
- Include limited-edition packaging to create exclusivity



Engagement & Growth Tactics

Influencer Strategy

- Partner with micro coffee + lifestyle creators (10K–50K followers)
- Invite creators to document the “Nitro Moment”
- Prioritize authentic in-store experiences over scripted ads

Interactive Community Campaigns

- “Where Should Nitro Go Next?”
- Seasonal menu voting
- Limited-edition merch giveaways
- UGC repost campaigns

Geo-Targeted Awareness Campaigns

- Run Instagram & TikTok ads in target cities
- Highlight Nitro’s craft and atmosphere
- Promote online bean & merch shipping

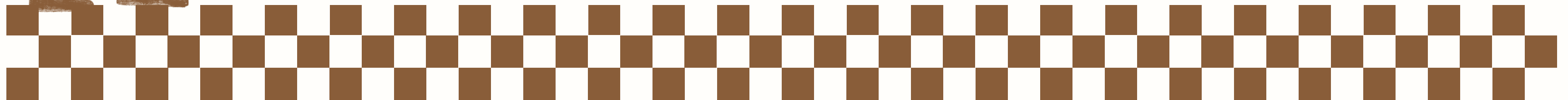




Metrics & Measurement

Key Performance Indicators

- Follower growth across Instagram and TikTok
- Growth in followers from target geographic markets
- Engagement rate (likes, comments, shares, saves)
- Average video views on Reels and TikTok
- Website traffic generated from social media
- Online sales of coffee beans and merchandise
- Reach and performance of geo-targeted paid ads
- User-generated content participation





Challenges & Solutions

Challenge 1: Competing with large coffee chains

- Solution: Lean into craft, founder story, and innovation differentiation.

Challenge 2: Perceived as only a regional brand

- Solution: Geo-targeted campaigns + influencer collaborations in target cities.

Challenge 3: Social media oversaturation of “aesthetic cafés”

- Solution: Emphasize storytelling depth and menu innovation rather than surface visuals.

Challenge 4: Maintaining authenticity while scaling

- Solution: Continue founder presence and behind-the-scenes content. Integrate customer-driven preferences (e.g., drink flavors, pastries, merch colorways) into menu development and product drops.





Conclusion & Next Steps



Nitro Bar has the foundation of a strong regional brand. This strategy transforms it into a scalable, premium, craft-driven lifestyle coffee brand.

- Develop 3-month content calendar
- Launch micro-influencer partnerships within 30 days
- Initiate geo-targeted ad campaigns in 2–3 key cities
 - Monitor engagement & regional data weekly
 - Adjust strategy based on performance metrics

